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Confidently Filled, Rarely Correlated

The Staff Car-Park Priority Score Against Independent Commuting-Need Measures

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The problem

The staff car-park Priority Score folds commute distance, caregiving flags, and shift timing into one renewal rank. What the score orders, once a form is in, has not been examined.

Research questions

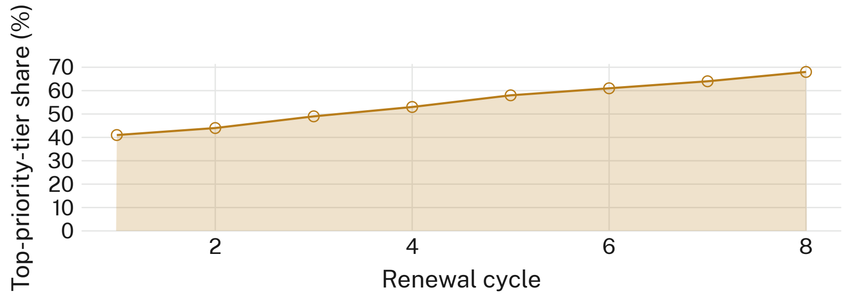
- Does rank track independent commuting-need measures?
- Does rank track form-completion behaviour instead?
- Does rank agree with a blind need-panel's rank?

Study design

- n = 214 renewals, two intake rounds · need proxies pulled independently of the form
- Ordinal logistic model of rank on need proxies and on form-completion measures
- Thresholds pre-registered before the second round; none adjusted post hoc

What we found

No reliable association with the combined need proxies (r = 0.09, n.s.). Rank tracked the form-completeness index closely (r = 0.71), and agreed with a blind three-member need-panel on 61 of 214 renewals (kappa = 0.19).



The top form-completeness quartile's share of top-priority-tier renewals rose from 41% in Cycle 1 (Feb 2023) to 68% in Cycle 8 (Mar 2026), while the top commuting-need quartile's share held flat at 34–37% across the same span.

What it means

Score rank tracks how a form was filled in far more reliably than what it was filled in about. The gap widened steadily across eight renewal cycles rather than settling. Next: pilot a completeness-blind resubmission window before the ninth intake round.

Selected references

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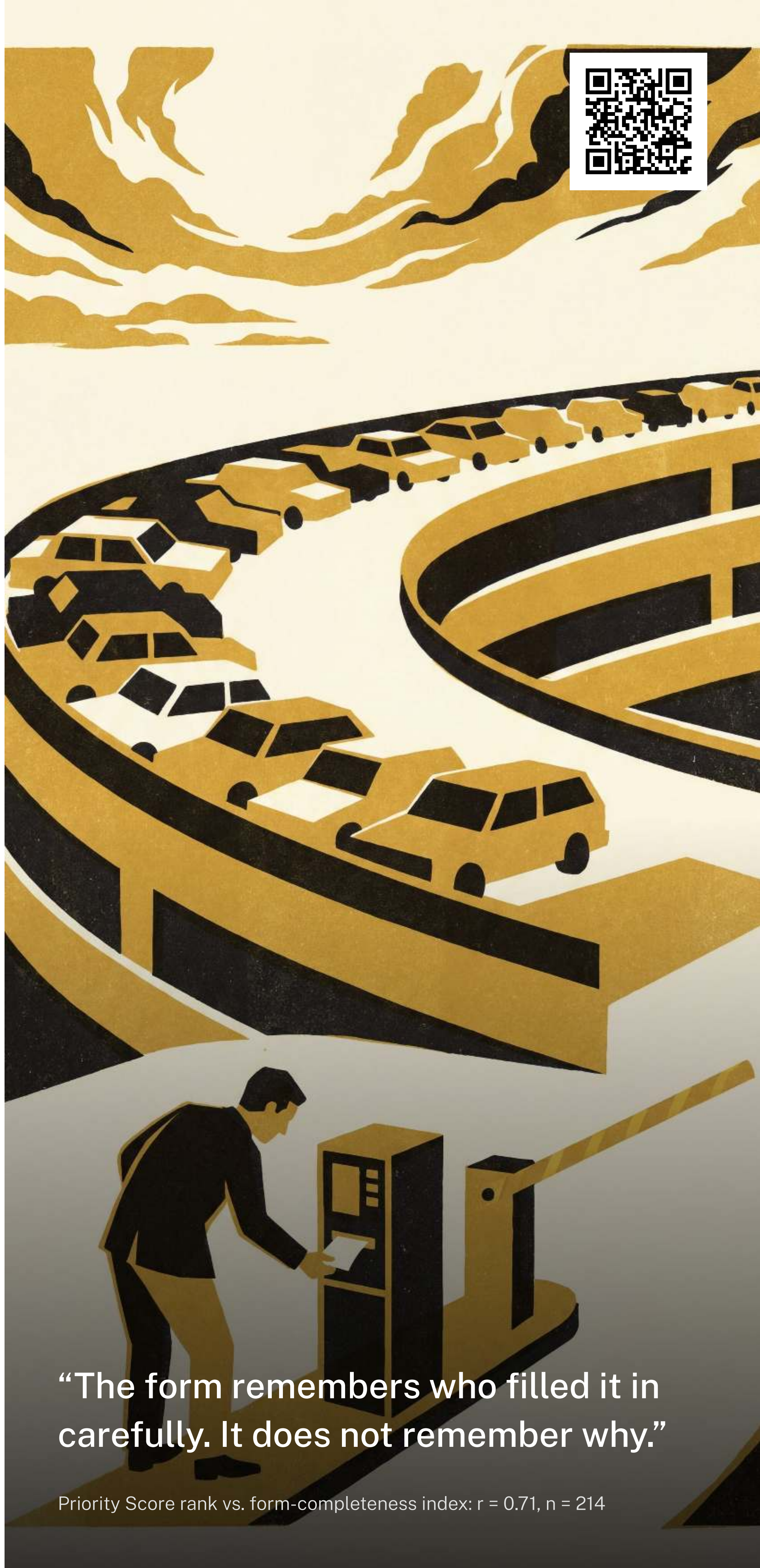
Ethics approval 2025/183; permit records de-identified before analysis, no plate numbers retained.



Priority Score rank vs. form-completeness index: r = 0.71, n = 214